

This guide explains what cryptodash does, what you will see on the dashboard, what the system does automatically, and what you need to do as a user. No technical knowledge required.

Generated 05 June 2026

1. What is cryptodash?

cryptodash is a personal crypto trading assistant running on your Raspberry Pi. It watches a list of coins 24 hours a day, analyses market conditions using technical indicators, reads recent news, and uses the Claude AI to generate plain English buy/sell/hold signals.

When market conditions are right it automatically places paper trades (simulated trades with no real money) via Freqtrade. When you are ready and confident in the signals, you can switch to live trading with one setting change.

What cryptodash does for you automatically:

- Watches your coin watchlist 24/7
- Calculates 9 technical indicators every 10 minutes
- Reads crypto news headlines every 30 minutes
- Checks the market Fear & Greed level every hour
- Generates an AI signal (Strong Buy → Strong Sell) for each coin
- Places paper trades automatically when all conditions are met
- Monitors open trades for stop loss, take profit and time stop
- Scans the top 100 coins every hour for new opportunities
- Sends desktop notifications when trades open or close

What you need to do:

- Check the dashboard when you want to — no schedule required
- Review learning analysis recommendations every few weeks
- Decide whether to add scanner opportunities to your watchlist
- Switch to live trading when you are confident (your decision, never automatic)

2. The Two Screens

There are two web interfaces running on your Pi. You access both from a browser on your local network.

Screen	Address	What it shows	How often to check
cryptodash	http://localhost:3000	Signals, indicators, scanner, backtest	Whenever you want — signals update every 10 minutes
FreqUI (Freqtrade)	http://localhost:8080	Open trades, trade history, P&L, bot status	When you get a notification, or daily review

3. Understanding the Signals

Every coin on your watchlist gets a signal classification updated every 10 minutes. The signal is generated by Claude AI after analysing all 9 technical indicators, recent news, and market sentiment.

STRONG BUY	BUY	HOLD	SELL	STRONG SELL
Signal	What it means		What the bot does	
STRONG BUY	All 9 entry criteria met with high conviction. Indicators aligned, paper trading acceptable. 10% if target reached within 50 candles.		Plays scalping strategy. Acceptable 10% if target reached within 50 candles.	
BUY	Most criteria met but one is marginal. Reasonable setup. Paper trading acceptable.		Holds position until high conviction for automatic trade if you have an open position.	
HOLD	Mixed signals. Setup is incomplete or timing is poor. Nothing to act on.		Nothing. Wait for a clearer signal.	
SELL	Indicators lean bearish. If you have an open position, consider tightening your stop loss.		If position tightening closes signal. Reversal is on: closes on next candle.	
STRONG SELL	Multiple bearish signals aligned. High probability of follow down.		Closes any open position on the next hour candle automatically.	

4. The 9 Entry Criteria for a Trade

A STRONG BUY signal is only generated when ALL 9 of the following criteria are met simultaneously. If even one fails the signal will be BUY, HOLD, or lower. This is intentionally strict — you would rather miss a good trade than enter a bad one.

#	Criteria	Plain English	Currently failing because...
1	Price above 200 EMA	Coin is in a confirmed long-term uptrend.	BTC most is currently 41% below its 200 EMA. The long-term trend is down.
2	RSI between 25 and 45	Coin has pulled back and is oversold but not too far.	Most coins are selling during a dip, not chasing a rally.
3	Price within 5% of 50 EMA	Price is at its natural mean reversion point.	Price is far below 50 EMA, back from downtrend.
4	MACD above zero	Momentum is still net positive despite the pullback.	MACD is deeply negative and still trending down.
5	StochRSI below 30 and trending up	A more sensitive momentum indicator confirms the uptrend.	StochRSI is below 30 and still trending down.
6	Volume above 1.2x average	Real buyers are present. A move on low volume is suspect.	Volume is suspect and likely to fail.
7	Funding rate not above +0.05%	Futures traders are not dangerously overleveraged.	Funding rate is already entering into a squeeze.
8	Fear & Greed below 60	Market is not in a euphoric state. You never want to be greedy.	Fear & Greed is 12, only past fear or neutrality.
9	No high-weight negative news	No major negative catalyst in recent news.	Depends on your view — a check of the news is needed.

■ Why no trades are firing right now:

- Bitcoin is approximately 41% below its 200 EMA — the market is in a confirmed downtrend
- The strategy correctly refuses to enter downtrends — this is working as designed
- MACD is deeply negative and StochRSI is elevated — further confirmation of bearish conditions
- The bot is doing its job: protecting capital by staying out of bad setups
- Trades will fire automatically when BTC recovers and coins start meeting all 9 criteria

5. What Happens When a Trade Fires

When all 9 Claude criteria AND all 4 Freqtrade confirmation checks pass simultaneously, a trade is placed automatically. Here is the complete sequence of events:

1	Signal generated Every 10 minutes Claude AI evaluates all 9 criteria. At some point all 9 pass — signal becomes STRONG BUY.
2	Freqtrade confirms At the top of the next hour Freqtrade reads the signal, independently checks EMA200, RSI, MACD and volume on its own data.
3	Trade placed All checks pass. Freqtrade places a dry-run BUY order at current market price. Position size = 1% portfolio risk ÷ 5% stop loss = ~£200 position.
4	You get a notification "Auto trade: BUY BTC/GBP @ £69,240 SL: £65,778 TP: £76,164"
5	Trade monitored every 60 seconds Freqtrade checks current price against stop loss and take profit every minute.
6	Trade closes — one of four ways Take profit (+10%), Stop loss (-5%), Time stop (72h), or Signal reversal.
7	You get a closing notification "TAKE PROFIT: BTC/GBP @ £76,164 Gain: +£18.29" or "STOP LOSS: BTC/GBP @ £65,778 Loss: -£11.69"
8	Trade recorded Full trade record saved including entry conditions, exit reason and P&L.; Learning analysis updates after every 5 closed trades.

6. Trade Mechanics — Numbers

Here is a concrete example of how a trade works financially, using a £1,000 paper trading portfolio and a BTC entry at £69,240:

	Calculation	Amount
Portfolio value	£1,000	£1,000.00
Risk per trade (1%)	£1,000 × 1%	£10.00
Stop loss distance	5% of entry	5%

Position size	$\text{£10 risk} \div 5\% \text{ stop}$	£200.00
Units purchased	$\text{£200} \div \text{£69,240}$	0.00289 BTC
Entry fee (0.40%)	$\text{£200} \times 0.40\%$	£0.80
Stop loss price	$\text{£69,240} \times 95\%$	£65,778
Take profit price	$\text{£69,240} \times 110\%$	£76,164
Time stop	72 hours after entry	72h

Outcome	What happens	Net result
Take profit hits £76,164	Freqtrade sells at £76,164. Exit fee 0.25% (£0.50).	+£18.29 (+9.1%)
Stop loss hits £65,778	Freqtrade sells at ~£65,664 (0.17% slippage). Exit fee 0.40% (£0.76).	-£5.56 (-5.8%)
72h time stop	Freqtrade closes at market price after 72 hours.	Depends on price at 72h
Signal reversal	STRONG SELL signal fires. Freqtrade closes on next hour candle.	Depends on price at exit

7. The Dashboard Tabs — What Each One Does

Watchlist

Your main view.

- Shows live prices, 24h change and signal badge for each coin
- Signal subrow beneath each coin shows the AI summary in plain English
- Gauge row shows all indicators at a glance (RSI bar, MACD arrow, etc)
- Click "▼ explain indicators" to expand a full breakdown with plain English explanations
- Strategy Alignment section shows which of the 9 entry criteria are passing or failing
- Click any sparkline to open a full candlestick chart with volume and RSI panels
- Use "+ Add coin" to add a new coin to your watchlist
- Click a coin tag to remove it from your watchlist

Opportunities

The market scanner — finds coins outside your watchlist worth watching.

- Scans the top 100 Binance coins every hour
- Shows a single best candidate meeting Tier 0 (new riser) or Tier C (dip in uptrend) criteria
- Tier 0 (NEW RISER badge): coin just broke above its 200 EMA with volume — early entry
- Tier C (DIP IN UPTREND badge): coin in confirmed uptrend pulling back to 50 EMA
- If blank: no qualifying candidates found — the filters are working correctly
- "Scan Now" button triggers an immediate scan
- Use "Add to Watchlist" to add the candidate — Freqtrade will then monitor it

Backtest

Historical analysis of how signals would have performed.

- Select a coin and timeframe and click "Run Backtest"
- Shows market phase (bull/bear/mixed) for the test period
- £100 simulation shows what £100 would have become following the signals
- Phase-split analysis shows win rate in bull vs bear conditions
- Equity curve compares strategy performance against buy-and-hold
- Use this to understand signal quality before going live

Portfolio

Paper trading monitor — coming soon.

- Will show open positions, trade history and performance stats
- For now use FreqUI at <http://localhost:8080> to monitor trades

8. FreqUI — Monitoring Trades

FreqUI at <http://localhost:8080> is the Freqtrade interface. This is where you see actual paper trades, open positions and trade history. Log in with username "cryptodash" and the password you set in the config.

Section	What you see
Trade view	Shows open trades with entry price, current price, profit/loss and stop loss level. The EMA200 and RSI are p
Dashboard	Overview of bot performance, wallet balance over time and profit summary.
Bot status	Shows whether the bot is running (green) or stopped. "Dry run" badge confirms no real money is being used
Trade history	All closed trades with entry, exit, reason and P&L. Close reasons: roi (take profit), stop_loss, time_stop_72h

9. Notifications

Your Pi sends desktop notifications for key events. You do not need to have the dashboard open — notifications appear on the Pi desktop automatically.

Notification	What it means	Action needed?
"Auto trade: BUY BTC/GBP @ £XX"	Freqtrade has placed a paper trade. All 13 checks passed	No — check FreqUI if curious
"TAKE PROFIT: BTC/GBP +£XX"	Trade hit the 10% target and closed profitably.	No — review in FreqUI
"STOP LOSS: BTC/GBP -£XX"	Trade dropped 5% and closed at the stop loss.	No — normal risk management working
"TIME STOP: BTC/GBP after 72h"	Trade did not hit either target in 72 hours and was closed	No — check what conditions looked like
"Signal reversal exit: BTC/GBP"	Signal flipped to SELL while trade was open. Closed early	No — check new signal in dashboard
"Daily loss limit reached"	Auto trading suspended for the rest of the day.	No — resumes automatically at midnight
"Learning Analysis ready — X recommendations"	Enough trades have closed to generate learning insights	Yes — review recommendations in Portfolio tab

"Scanner: new opportunity found"	A coin outside your watchlist meets Tier 0 or Tier C criteria	Optional — check Opportunities tab, add to watchlist
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10. Learning Analysis — Making the System Smarter

After every 5 closed trades the system analyses what conditions led to winning vs losing trades and generates recommendations to improve the strategy. This is the only part of the system that requires your active input.

Trades closed	Analysis level	What you see
5	Early Signals	Basic stats only. Win rate, average gain/loss. No recommendations yet — too few trades.
10	First Analysis	Up to 2 recommendations with LOW confidence. e.g. "RSI below 35 wins 64% vs 28% for RSI above 35"
20	Full Analysis	Up to 4 recommendations with MEDIUM confidence. All correlations run.
30+	High Confidence	Full recommendation set with HIGH confidence where data supports it.

How to handle a recommendation:

1	Get a notification "Learning Analysis ready — 2 recommendations available in Portfolio tab"
2	Open the Portfolio tab Go to http://localhost:3000 and click Portfolio
3	Read the recommendation Example: "Tighten RSI filter from 25-45 to 25-35. Win rate at RSI 25-35: 64% (18 trades) vs RSI 35-45: 28% (7 trades). Estimated impact: ~30% fewer signals, +12% win rate"
4	Accept or Reject Click Accept to update the strategy parameter automatically, or Reject to keep the current setting. Both decisions are logged.
5	System updates If accepted, the strategy parameter updates immediately. The next signals will reflect the new setting.

11. Going Live — When and How

Switching from paper trading to real money is a deliberate manual step. The system will never move real money without you explicitly enabling it. Here is when you should consider going live and exactly how to do it.

When you are ready to go live — checklist:

	Requirement	Why
■	Paper trading running for 60+ days	Enough trade history for meaningful statistical analysis
■	Win rate above 40% on paper trades	Minimum threshold for a viable strategy
■	Risk/reward ratio above 1.5:1	Wins must meaningfully outweigh losses net of fees
■	No daily loss limit hits in last 2 weeks	Strategy is stable and not over-trading
■	At least one learning analysis completed (10+ trades)	System has self-reviewed and recommendations actioned
■	Kraken account verified and funded with GBP	Real account ready to receive trades
■	Kraken API keys generated with trading permissions	Keys ready but not yet in the system
■	Start at 50% position sizes for first 2 weeks	Reduce real money risk while validating live execution

How to switch to live trading:

1	Add Kraken API keys to Freqtrade config Edit <code>/home/gallus23/freqtrade/user_data/config.json</code> . Set <code>exchange.key</code> and <code>exchange.secret</code> to your Kraken trading keys.
2	Set <code>dry_run</code> to false In the same config file change <code>"dry_run": true</code> to <code>"dry_run": false</code>
3	Restart Freqtrade <code>sudo systemctl restart freqtrade</code>
4	Verify in FreqUI Open <code>http://localhost:8080</code> — the "Dry run" badge should be gone. Check wallet balance shows your real Kraken GBP balance.
5	Monitor closely for first week Check FreqUI daily. Confirm first live trade executes as expected. Compare live entry price to what paper trading would have given.

■ Important reminders for live trading:

- Never enable the Withdraw permission on your Kraken API key
- Start with 50% of your intended position sizes for the first 2 weeks
- The daily loss limit (£50) suspends auto trading if hit — check notifications
- You can switch back to `dry_run: true` at any time to pause live trading
- All trade decisions are still algorithmic — review FreqUI regularly

12. Suggested Daily Routine

You do not need to monitor the system constantly. Here is a simple routine that keeps you informed without requiring constant attention:

When	Action	Time needed
Morning (optional)	Glance at cryptodash watchlist — check signal classifications and any overnight changes	1 minute
When you get a trade notification	Check FreqUI to see the open position — entry price, stop loss, take profit	2 minutes
When you get a close notification	Check FreqUI trade history — was it take profit, stop loss, or time stop?	2 minutes
When learning analysis notifications arrive	Open Portfolio tab, read recommendations, Accept or Reject each one	5-10 minutes
Weekly	Review FreqUI dashboard — overall P&L, win rate, any patterns in losses	10 minutes
Monthly	Run a fresh backtest — check if signal quality is improving over time	5 minutes
When scanner finds opportunities	Check Opportunities tab — decide whether to add the coin to your watchlist	5 minutes

13. Common Questions

Why are there no trades?

The market is in a downtrend. BTC is below its 200 EMA which is the primary entry gate. The strategy correctly refuses to trade in downtrends. Trades will fire automatically when market conditions improve.

Why is my signal showing STRONG SELL?

Multiple bearish indicators are aligned — price below EMAs, negative MACD, low RSI momentum. This is accurate — the strategy is seeing real market weakness. No action needed.

The Opportunities tab is blank — is something broken?

No — blank means no coins in the top 100 meet the Tier 0 or Tier C criteria right now. In a bearish market this is the correct result. Try "Scan Now" to trigger a fresh scan.

My signal timestamp is old — is it updating?

Signals update every 10 minutes. Check the timestamp in the indicator panel. If it is more than 15 minutes old, check the cryptodash service is running: `sudo systemctl status crypto-dashboard`

FreqUI shows "Bot is stopped"

The Freqtrade service may have restarted. Check: `sudo systemctl status freqtrade`. If stopped: `sudo systemctl start freqtrade`

Both services still running after Pi restart?

Yes — both are configured as systemd services set to start on boot. cryptodash starts first, Freqtrade starts after it.

How do I add a new coin to the watchlist?

Click "+ Add coin" in the cryptodash watchlist tab. Enter the CoinGecko coin ID (e.g. "polkadot"). Also add the GBP pair to Freqtrade config.json pair_whitelist (e.g. "DOT/GBP") and restart Freqtrade.

Can I place a manual trade to test the system?

Yes — in FreqUI use the force entry button to place a test trade bypassing the signal logic. Useful for testing stop loss and take profit work correctly.

14. Disclaimer

cryptodash is a personal learning and research tool. All signals and trade simulations are algorithmic and educational in nature. They do not constitute financial advice. Cryptocurrency trading involves significant risk of loss — you can lose all of your investment. Past performance of paper trades does not guarantee future results with real money. Never invest more than you can afford to lose. Always do your own research. The developer accepts no liability for any financial losses incurred.